

Detailed Breakdown

- `socket.auth`: This is a built-in object provided by the Socket.IO client library designed specifically for storing authentication data.
- `userId: user.id`: Identifies the unique database ID of the user trying to establish the connection.
- `token: user.token`: Usually a JSON Web Token (JWT) or API key used to prove the user's identity to the server.  Socket.IO v4

How It Works (The Lifecycle)

```

[ Server ]
|
|
Attaches { userId, token } to socket.auth |
Sends connection handshake request ----->|
|
|-- 3. Intercepts with middleware
|-- 4. Validates token & checks userId
|   |-- If valid: allows connection
5. Connection Established (or Rejected) -----|   |-- If invalid: rejects connection

```



object to the server during the initial HTTP handshake phase.

3. **Server Verification:** The server intercepts this data using a Socket.IO middleware block: hayatscodes.hashnode.dev +4

javascript



```
// Example Server-Side Middleware Code
io.use((socket, next) => {
  const { userId, token } = socket.handshake.auth; // Receives data from client

  if (isValidToken(token, userId)) {
    socket.userId = userId; // Attaches data to server-side socket instance
    next(); // Connection allowed
  } else {
    next(new Error("Authentication failed")); // Connection rejected
  }
});
```

Why Use `socket.auth` Instead of Query Strings?

- **Security:** Passing tokens via URL query strings (e.g., `io('/?token=xyz')`) is bad practice because URLs can be logged by web servers, proxies, and browser history. `socket.auth` sends data securely inside the connection payload. WordPress.com +4
- **Auto-Reconnection:** If the network drops, Socket.IO will automatically try to reconnect. It will safely reuse the credentials stored in `socket.auth` every time it reconnects. Stack Overflow



Stack Overflow

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socket.dev

<https://docs.socket.dev> › reference › authentication

Authentication - Socket.dev

This page will explain how **Socket API authentication** works. **Socket's** API uses organization **tokens** for authenticating requests. [Read more](#)



SocketCluster

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Authentication

Once you have the **token** on the client side, you need to add it to localStorage under the key '**socketcluster.authToken**' (this is the default JWT localStorage key ... [Read more](#)



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